

TEACHING TIPS:

- This is a great song to **cheer everyone up** on a rainy day! Each of the four parts is easy to learn and will sound impressive sung altogether.
- Teach all the parts to everyone first before splitting the class into four groups and **allocating each a verse**. You might like to have equally-sized groups or small groups for verses 1-3 and a larger group for verse 4 – it's up to you.
- Encourage the children to listen carefully to the track to help them know when to come in. At first it will be helpful to **conduct the entries**.
- Make sure that the verse 1 singers put the 'p' on the end of each 'drip, drop' and remember to watch the conductor for their final line, 'we've gotta stop'.
- You might like to try singing without the backing track and **experimenting** with the groups starting and stopping at different times.
- A performance with children wearing wellies and raincoats, and some **choreography** involving umbrellas, would be great fun!

WHAT YOU NEED

Percussion instruments e.g. xylophones, rainmakers, shakers

LOOK

For **more inspiration** for your rainy-day soundscape, have a look at this fun body-percussion soundscape by Perpetuum Jazzile:

www.youtube.com/watch?v=c3LjvUzxm5E

Or try this simple version with the class:

www.youtube.com/watch?v=xgKy1gCugKY

Talk about the different **timbres**, **dynamics** and **textures** that are produced.

TIMBRE

The character or quality of a musical sound

TEXTURE

Layers of rhythm and sound

DYNAMICS

Volume

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES
5-7

Rainy-day percussion

Discuss how you could **represent rain sounds** using percussion instruments and body percussion. Would metallic or wooden instruments sound best? Can the children make a 'drip' sound with their mouths, as if they were fish? You might like to listen to the backing track on its own for inspiration.

As a class, decide which instruments/sounds (timbres) would be best for each verse. As a starting point, you could try the following:

Verse 1: mouths

Verse 2: fingers patting on desks

Verse 3: xylophones playing the 'it's raining, it's pouring' motif using the notes C A F

Verse 4: rainmakers and shakers for 'April showers'

Try performing along with the vocal track, or splitting the class in half and having half singing, half playing.

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To explore texture and timbre.

To perform in four parts as an ensemble.

To improvise a percussive accompaniment.